Publish a website with GitHub Pages

Digital Technologies · School and personal computers

You will

- turn on GitHub Pages for your repository
- visit your website at its own link

You need

- a repository with `index.html` in it, committed and pushed (see the guide Commit and push in VS Code)

Before you start

- Your home page must be called `index.html`, in the main folder of the repository, not inside another folder.

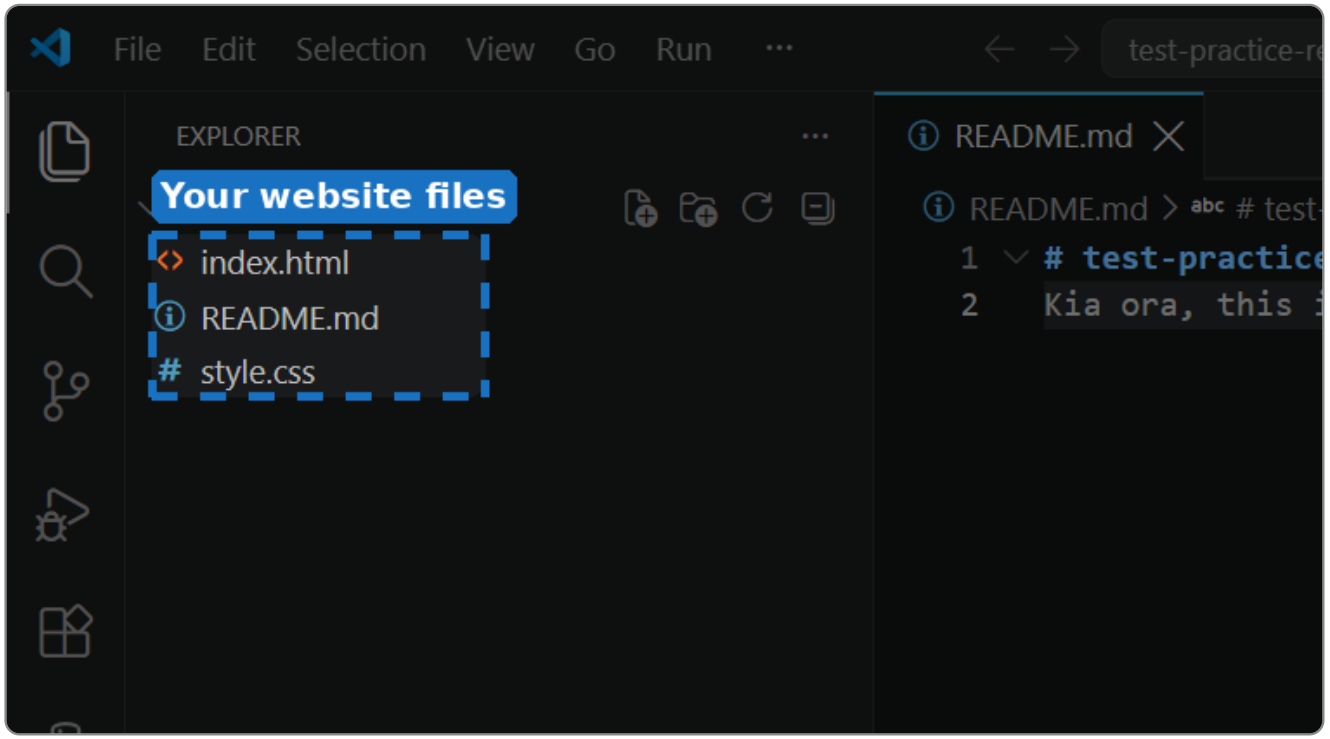
 Click here  Look here

1

VS Code › Explorer

Check `index.html` and your other website files are in your repository.

Commit and push them in VS Code if you haven't yet.



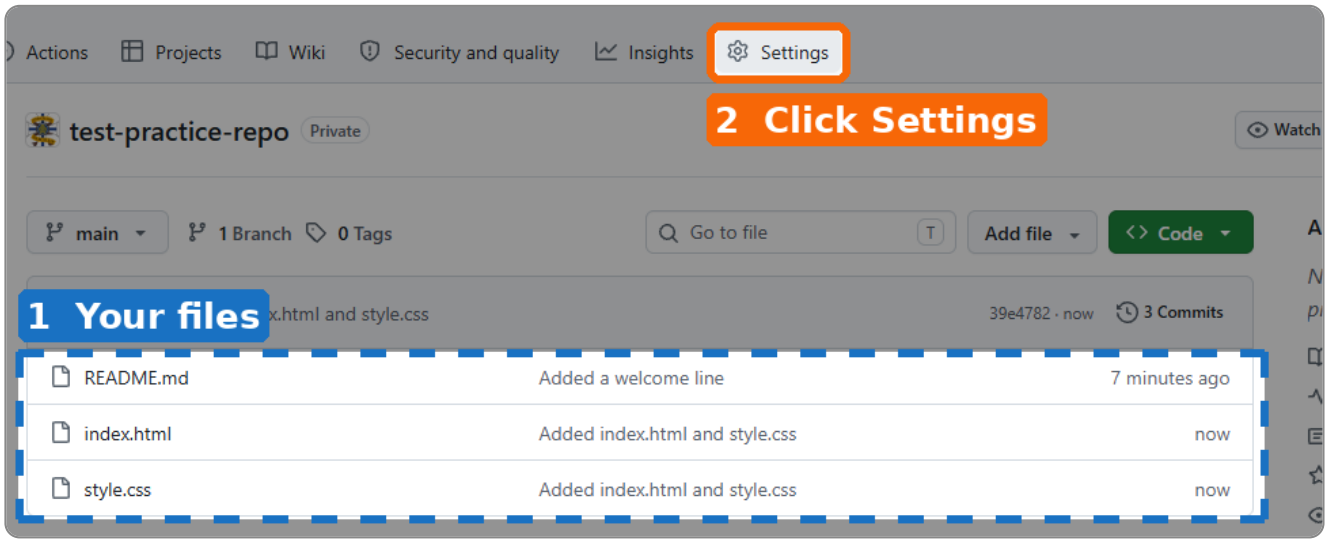
2

GitHub › your repository

Check your files are on GitHub.

Click the **Settings** tab.

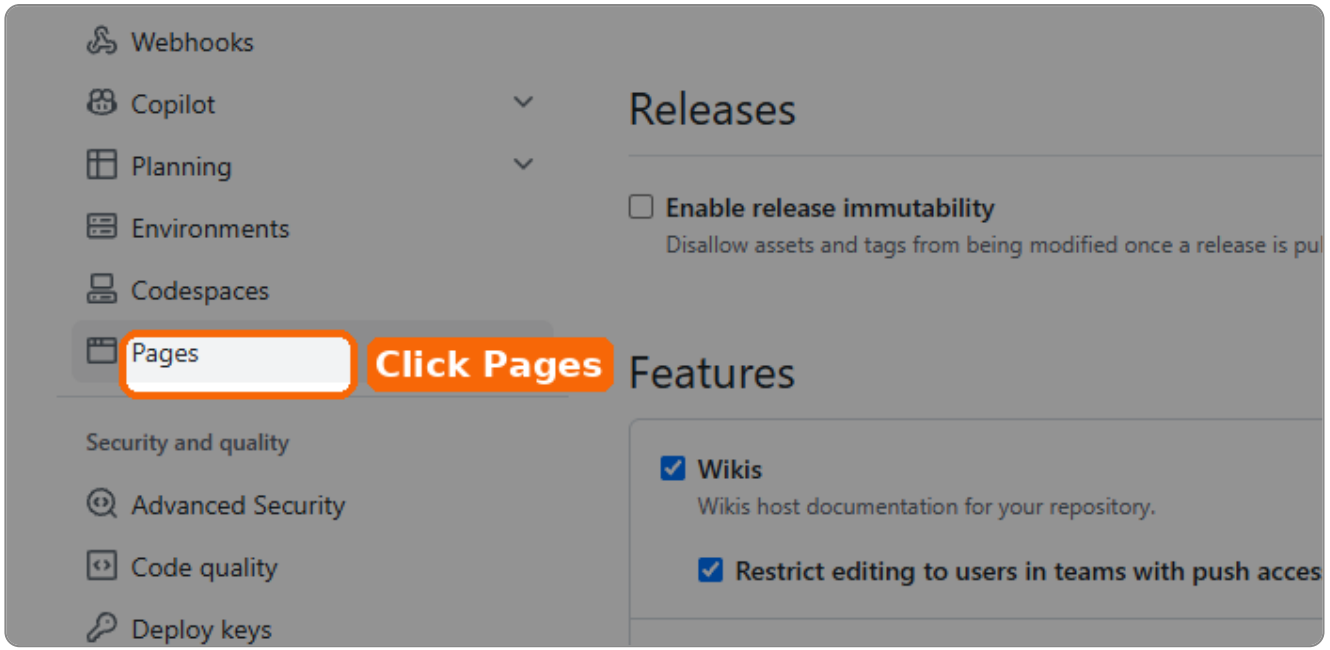
If something goes wrong
No Settings tab: click the **...** at the end of the tabs, or make the window wider.



3

GitHub › Settings

In the left menu, click **Pages**.



4

GitHub › Settings › Pages

Check **Source** says **Deploy from a branch**.

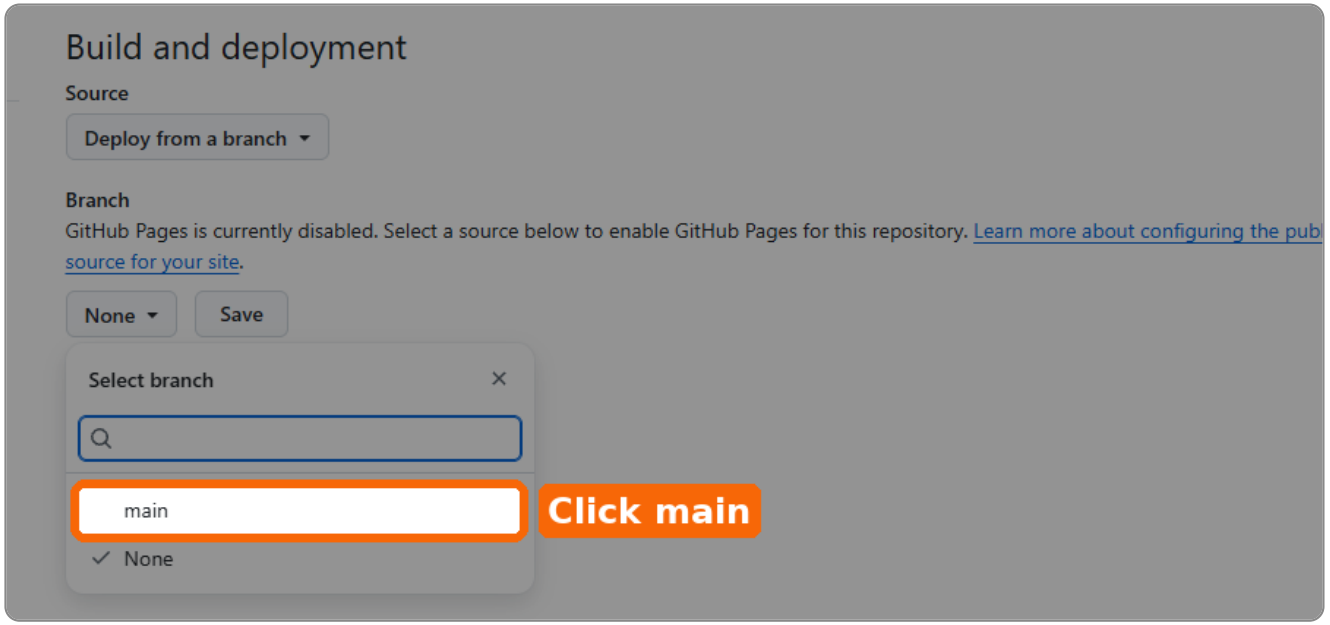
Under **Branch**, click **None**.



5

GitHub › Select branch

Click **main**.

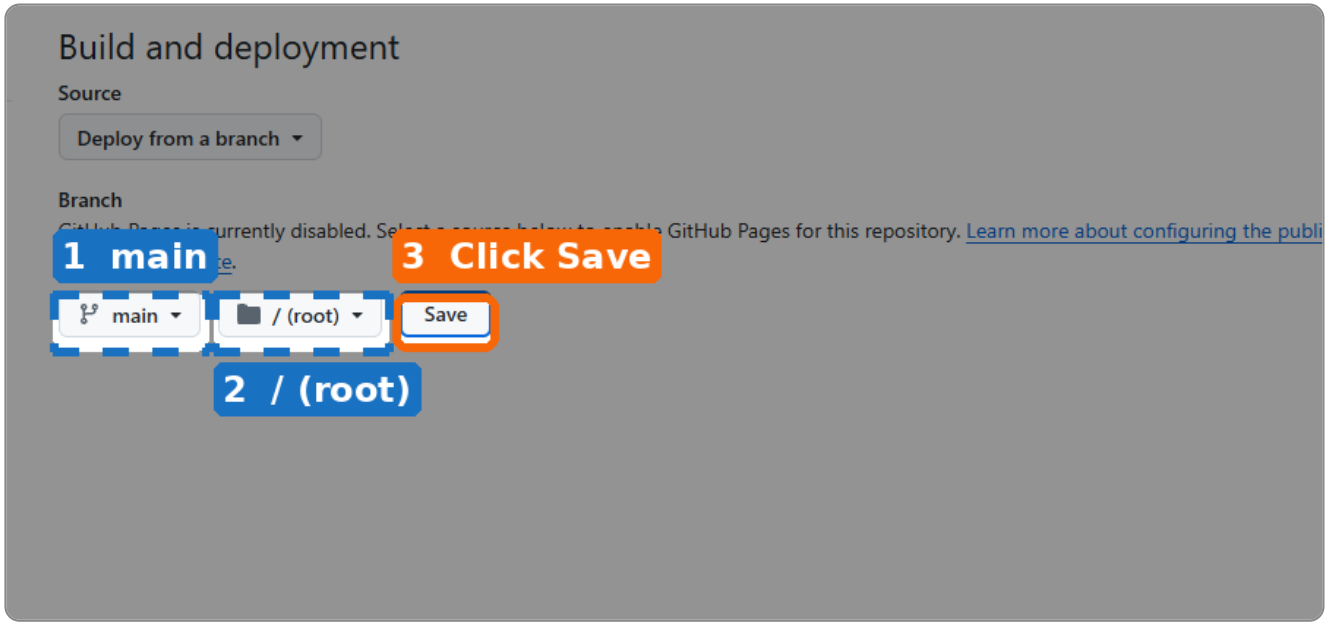


6

GitHub › Settings › Pages

Check it shows **main** and **/ (root)**.

Click **Save**.

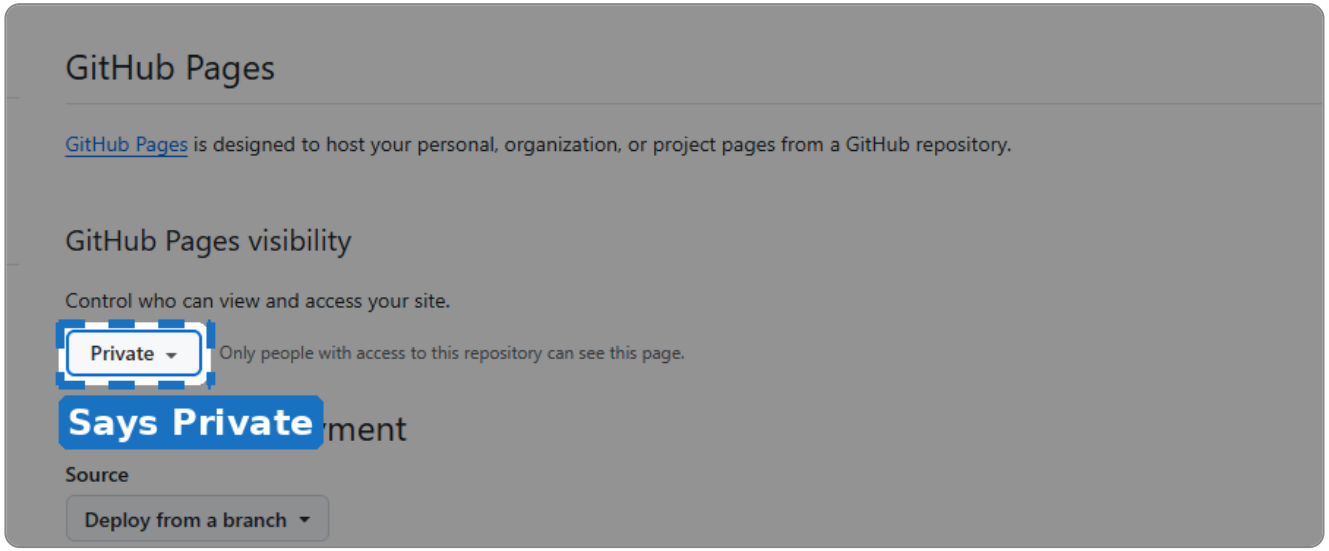


7

GitHub › Settings › Pages

Check **GitHub Pages visibility** says **Private**.

Private means only people with access to your repository, like you and your kaiako, can see the site.



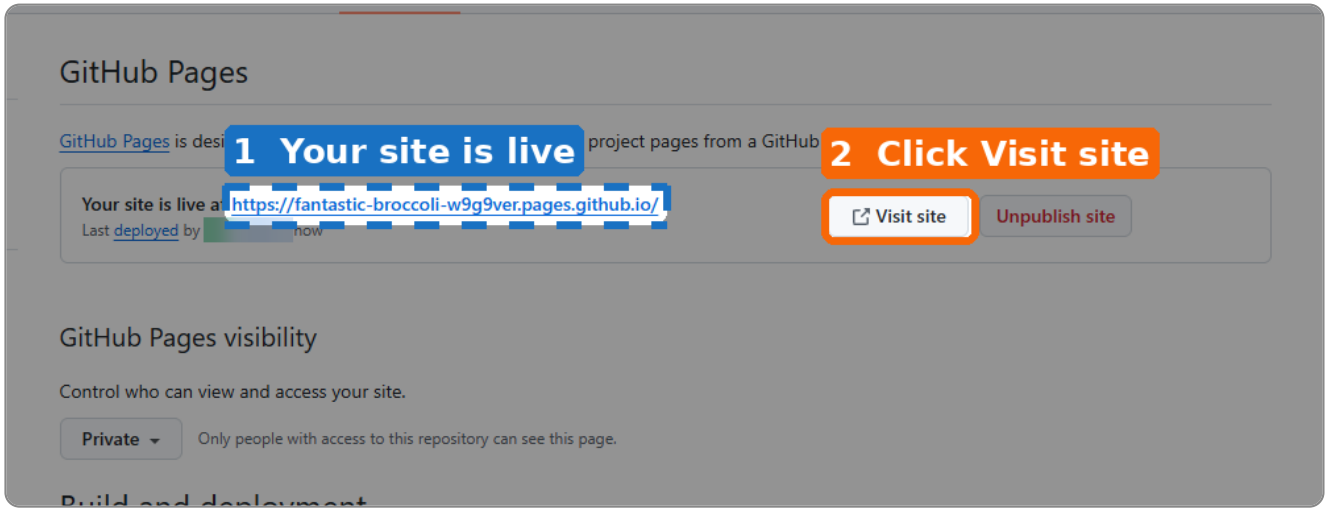
8

GitHub › Settings › Pages

Wait a minute or two, then refresh the page (F5).

When it says **Your site is live at**, click **Visit site**.

Keep refreshing until the link appears. The first time can take a few minutes.



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Chrome › your website

Look at your website.

> **Check:** your page shows, and the address ends in `github.io`.

If something goes wrong

You see a 404 page: wait a minute and refresh. Still 404? Check your home page is called index.html, in lowercase.



Updating your site
Every time you commit and push, GitHub updates your site by itself. Wait a minute, then refresh.

Finding your link again
On your repository's main page, click **github-pages** under **Deployments** on the right.

Checkpoint

- [ ] I turned on GitHub Pages from the main branch.
- [ ] I visited my live website.
- [ ] I know my site updates when I push.

